Project Proposal

Business Intelligence Implementation

Joshua Schwenk

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Executive Summary

Baker Tilly, a top 10 public accounting firm, is seeking to enhance its data capabilities through the implementation of Tableau as a complementary Business Intelligence (BI) and Business Analytics (BA) tool along with Power BI. While Power BI excels in the Microsoft ecosystem, its limitations in cross-platform integrations outside this environment and large-scale collaboration create challenges in today's multi-system, data-driven landscape.

This proposal outlines the need for Tableau to support seamless integration with a broader range of data sources, streamline collaboration across departments, and provide advanced visualization features that support faster and more informed decision-making. Tableau's compatibility with Power BI's semantic model ensures continuity while expanding analytics across non-Microsoft systems.

The implementation includes a robust system architecture that integrates Azure, AWS, and Snowflake. This provides scalable, secure, and centralized data storage. Tableau will serve as the core platform for unified reporting and cross-functional insights. Ultimately, this will reduce data silos and decision-making latency.

To support the transition, Baker Tilly must invest in specialized personnel such as BI architects, data engineers, and cybersecurity professionals. Due to current staff being familiar with the existing Power BI infrastructure, ample training must be implemented to upskill employees on Tableau's features, functionality, and integration practices. This will ensure they can confidently build, interpret, and maintain dashboards in the new environment.

Risks such as staff shortages, technical compatibility, and user resistance have been identified and mitigated through proactive planning. Additionally, data security and privacy measures will be reinforced with role-based access, encryption, regular audits, and adherence to regulations.

Baker Tilly will utilize the ADKAR model to guide employees through the change process. This will be essential for the success of the Tableau implementation and adoption. This framework emphasizes the human side of transformation by helping individuals understand the need for Tableau and reinforcing adoption through continued support and recognition. By applying this model, Baker Tilly can minimize resistance, accelerate adoption, and promote a culture of continuous innovation.

Implementing Tableau will position Baker Tilly for long-term success by empowering employees with better tools, strengthening client service delivery, and future-proofing the firm's analytical structure. By embracing Tableau, Baker Tilly can foster a culture of data-driven decision-making and ensure continued growth and innovation in an increasingly competitive market.

Organizational Overview

Baker Tilly is a top 10 Public Accounting firm that specializes in tax, assurance, and advisory. The firm provides professional services to clients in the realm of tax regulation, compliance, and enhances business practices utilizing a data-driven approach. The company employs data analytics for financial reporting, auditing, consulting, and for their internal operations. Baker Tilly manages several systems and technology internally and externally, including Amazon Web Services (AWS), AuditBoard, Deltek, iCIMS, IFS, Oracle, Microsoft, Power BI, Sage Intacct, Snowflake, UltiPro, and Workiva (Baker Tilly, n.d.). Since on many occasions they will need to use their client's software, the number of systems they encounter is limitless.

Business Need

Baker Tilly currently has a Business Intelligence Software program called Power BI. This is a Microsoft licensed product and integrates seamlessly with the Microsoft Ecosystem. However, integration may be limited to other systems outside the Microsoft brand (Biswal, 2025). Additionally, the software is only officially available for Windows OS and cannot be used on Mac or Linux OS (Anurodh, 2024). If Baker Tilly is working with a client who utilizes one of these operating systems, they will need to find a workaround to merge the data into Power BI. Power BI has dashboard creation tools that can be shared but focuses more on the individual user (Biswal, 2025). When sharing reports, the recipient must have Power BI Pro, unless the report is in a premium capacity (kfollis, 2024).

The challenge Baker Tilly faces is integration and collaboration. Baker Tilly operates on a wide variety of software outside of Microsoft, not all of which integrate with Power BI. An example of this is iCIMS (Application Tracking System) and UltiPro (Human Resources Information System) not being able to run combined reports efficiently as they do not integrate with each other. Though iCIMS has the ability to communicate with Power BI, UltiPro does not. One way around this issue is through manually merging the reports through SQL, but it is labor intensive and timely. This situation creates data silos, inconsistent reports, and slower decision making.

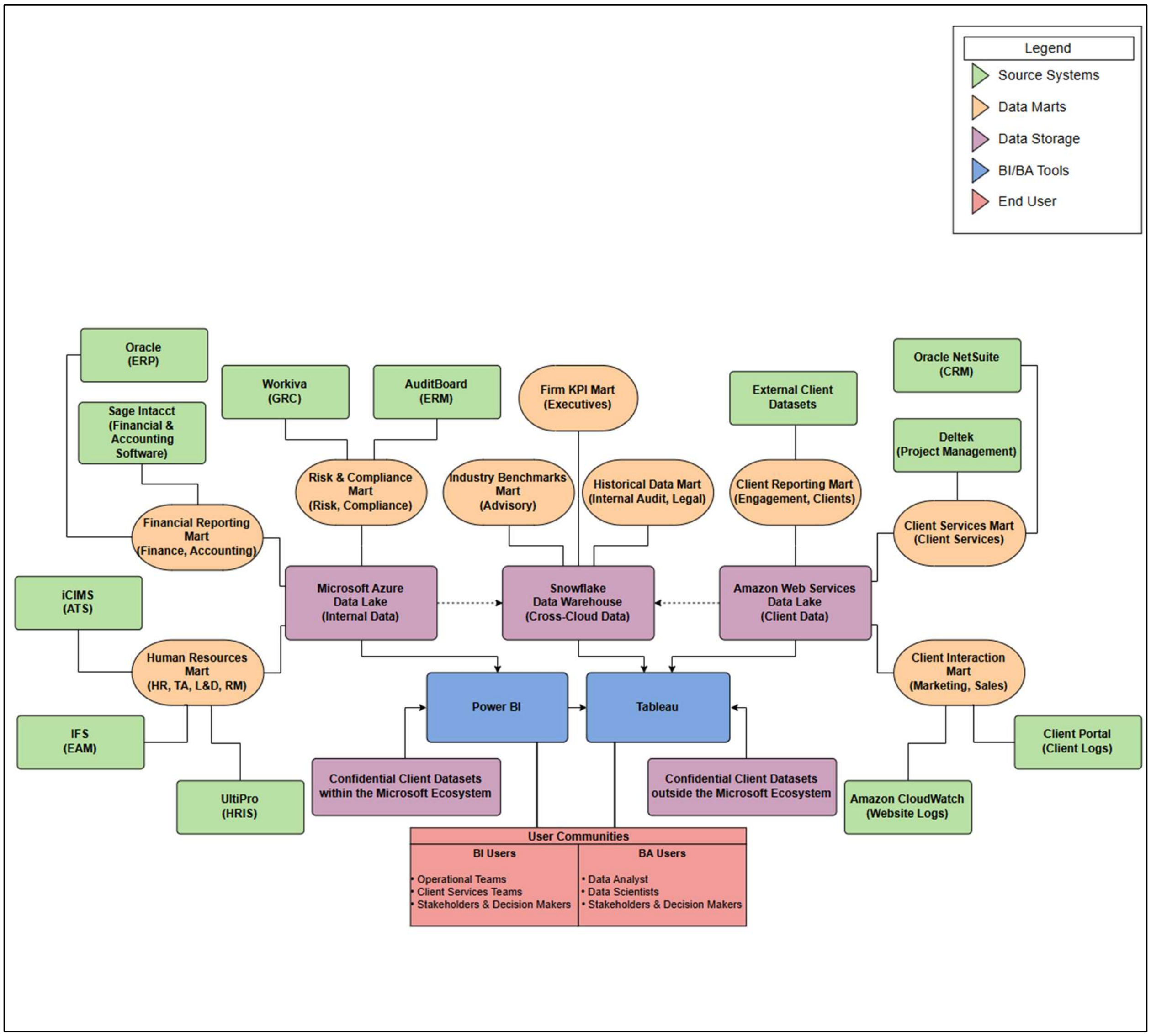
The firm would benefit from implementing a Business Intelligence system called Tableau, as a supplement for Power BI. Tableau offers a greater integration of systems outside the Microsoft Ecosystem (Biswal, 2025). The Power BI semantic model can also connect to Tableau, allowing for a wider range of interconnected systems (Buhler, n.d.). By having a centralized data system implemented by the entire organization, it will reduce data silos and allow smoother data flow. This will increase collaboration since all reports are feeding into a singular software. Tableau is known for its visualization and customization tools. It has enhanced collaboration features, allowing for the creation and sharing of interactive data (Biswal, 2025). Each dashboard can be tailored towards specific departments and are able to run reports leveraging data from other areas. Additionally, stakeholders are able to view up-to-date reports from each area of the firm. They will not have to wait for specific departments to submit their data, allowing them to make quicker and more informed decisions. Tableau is also superior in managing large datasets (Biswal, 2025). *Tableau Server Data Engine* (n.d.) outlines Tableau's in-memory Data engine called Hyper. Hyper technology enables faster extract creation, supports larger extracts, and creates faster analysis of extracts. This is accomplishable by higher optimization of the CPU and memory as it was designed to use advanced queries to optimize and consume data faster. This is ideal for Baker Tilly's cross-platform analytics as client software varies (G. Shelton, personal communication, April 14, 2025).

As Baker Tilly continues to grow, they will be less hindered by system latency. By the implementation of the new Business Intelligence software, Baker Tilly can address their challenges of data integration, centralized reporting, and real-time analysis. Ultimately, this will improve operational efficiencies, client service quality, and decision-making.

System Diagram

Figure 1

System Diagram for Business Intelligence/Business Analytics System



Note. This system diagram illustrates the data flow from multiple source systems (green) into data marts (orange) for processing. Data is then consolidated into storage (purple) in Microsoft Azure (internal data), Amazon Web Services (client data), or Snowflake (cross-cloud data). Power BI and Tableau (blue) pull the prepared datasets to create reports, dashboards, and insights for different user communities (red).

Figure 1 is a system's diagram for the Business Intelligence and Business Analysis tools. Baker Tilly utilizes a wide range of systems, and the infrastructure ensures secure, streamlined access to the right data for both internal and client facing needs. Data marts are embedded into the data warehouses and lakes. The data in the marts are controlled through the data source appropriate to their business function (e.g. HR marts pull data from UltiPro, IFS, and iCIMS).

There are three major data storage that Baker Tilly utilizes: Microsoft Azure, Amazon Web Services (AWS), and Snowflake. The organization lacks an on-premise data infrastructure and favors cloud computing. Microsoft Azure data lake will store data from the firm's internal databases. Many of Baker Tilly's internal systems are part of the Microsoft Ecosystem which integrate well into Azure. The dataset is stored in a data lake to support a "store everything" strategy commonly used in big data environments (Stair & Reynolds, 2018). The business will conduct the ETL (extract, transform, load) process when it leaves this data lake. Several of Baker Tilly client-facing portals, apps, services, or project tools are hosted through Amazon Web Services (AWS) making it an ideal place to store information. The data warehouse can scale up or down storage as client numbers grow or shrink. Additionally, AWS has strong built-in compliance standards where it encrypts all client data automatically (Slinger, 2025). Snowflake data cloud offers high scalability, fast processing, and cost-effective data storage. It will aggregate the data from the Azure and AWS systems to store firm KPI's, industry benchmarks, and historical data. The warehouse can handle the capacity from all of the data that will eventually flow into the system. Snowflake separates data storage from computer functions, which means you can run multiple queries without slowing down and access data from several warehouses simultaneously (Slinger, 2025). Though there are strict rules and regulations about the storing of external client data, individuals are often hesitant to allow a company to upload their data into a warehouse. Baker Tilly's BI and BA tools will be able to support connecting directly to the client's databases to perform real-time analysis and reporting without the need to permanently transfer or replicate sensitive data into the Baker Tilly environment. Additionally, Tableau supports embedded analytics allowing Baker Tilly to create interactive dashboards directly into client-facing portals or other internal tools. This supports security and trust as it allows for live client reporting and avoids compliance issues tied to storing external data (G. Shelton, personal communication, April 14, 2025).

Baker Tilly will take advantage of Power BI and Tableau as their Business Intelligence and Business Analytics Tools. Power BI, as a part of the Microsoft Ecosystem, will integrate data from the Azure data lake. Power BI has robust data modeling and ETL capability (Biswal, 2025). It allows for Excel and SQL Server integration which is beneficial for quick wins. The Power BI semantic model can also connect to Tableau, allowing for a wider range of interconnected systems (Buhler, n.d.). Since every data source eventually leads into Tableau, it can be a centralized BI and BA tool.

The end user community at Baker Tilly is divided based on how teams interact with the data. Operational teams and Client Services Teams primarily use BI tools to access dashboards and client engagement reports. Data Analysts and Scientists use BA tools for deeper trends analysis, predictive modeling, and scenario planning (Tableau, n.d.). Key stakeholders and decision makers rely both on BI and BA outputs to guide strategic initiatives, monitor firm performance, and drive client success.

Information Systems Personnel

The successful implementation and maintenance of Baker Tilly's Business Intelligence and Business Analytics software is dependent on the planning of information systems personnel. Three key aspects to consider are staffing levels, training, and change management.

First, the staffing levels should be evaluated and adjusted in order to provide support for the implementation and maintenance of Tableau. Project Managers will need to be put into place to monitor the progression of the integration. BI/BA Solution Architects will design the blueprint for the organization's data frame while the Data Engineers will help build and implement the architecture (Kutay, n.d.). To ensure connectivity within the systems, a Cloud Network Specialist can be assigned to manage the cloud-based service and monitor the cloud networks (Franklin University, n.d.). The migrating data from internal data lakes and client data warehouses to Baker Tilly's BI/BA systems will need to be clean first. An ETL Developer will be able to clean, transform, and load data from various sources and convert it into the format used in analysis (Stair & Reynolds, 2018). Data governance should be implemented through a governance committee and a Data Steward. The information systems team, as well as business leaders, will work cross-functionally to ensure that compliance needs are met. The Data Steward is responsible for managing the data elements, including creating and maintaining reference data and master data definitions and analyzing data for quality and correcting issues (Stair & Reynolds, 2018). Since Baker Tilly works heavily on sensitive data, a strong Cyber Security team should be in place in order to recognize and respond to potential threats, safeguard client information, and ensure compliance with regulations. The information systems team will need to be supplemented with additional BI Developers, Data Analysts, and Data Scientists who are experienced with multi-cloud environments. Without adequate staffing, the system could face delays in setup, inconsistent performance, or security vulnerabilities, which would undermine its effectiveness.

Second, training is essential to equip technical and business users to effectively utilize the new tool. Information systems personnel not only in administration and governance, but also in supporting the end users across the firm. Training programs should include platform certifications and internal workshops. Corporate Learning & Talent Development (L&D) will create a lesson plan that all information systems personnel must complete. These will entail dashboard creation, Power BI to Tableau dataset migration, and security best practices. These trainings can be accomplished through the assistance of Tableau, on Udemy, or created by the L&D function itself. A separate training syllabus will also be provided to key stakeholders and decision-makers to ensure they understand Tableau's capabilities, how to interpret dashboards, and drive data-informed initiatives across the organization.

Lastly, a change management model must be executed to secure a successful implementation of change. The technology acceptance model (TAM) identifies the factors that can lead to improved attitudes resulting in higher acceptance and usage (Stair & Reynolds, 2018). A Change Manager will be able to guide users' perceptions that this tool is both useful and easy to use.

By addressing staffing, training, and change management considerations early on, Baker Tilly can minimize risks and ensure a smooth transition to the new BI and BA environment.

Enterprise Risk Management

"Risk management is one of the most challenging disciplines in project management and it's also one of the most important" (Dionisio, 2021, 0:01). Implementing a new Business Intelligence and Business Analytics system at Baker Tilly introduces several potential risks that could impact the project's success. By identifying and assessing these risks early on, the firm can develop strategies to mitigate them. Table 1 outlines six top risks associated with the project along with their probability scores.

Table 1

Risk Assessment for Tableau System Implementation

Type of Risk	Risk Description	Probability
Operational	Staff shortages (PTO, sick leave, emergency leave) or turnover delay implementation.	2
Technical	Compatibility issues between Tableau and existing client systems.	3
Resources	Lack of skilled personnel (e.g. Cloud Specialists, Data Engineers) to manage the new system.	4
Training	Insufficient trainings leading to low system adoption.	3
Security	Data privacy concerns with client data storage and direct database access.	3
Change Management	Resistance to change from employees accustomed to Power BI only workflows.	5

Note. This table identifies six primary risks associated with implementing Tableau at Baker Tilly. Each risk is categorized by type, a brief description, and a probability score (1-5) estimating the likelihood of occurrence.

Operational Risk: Staff shortages or turnover present a low risk as employee absences are common but typically manageable with proper planning. To mitigate disruption, implementation milestones should avoid high-risk periods such as holiday season, tax season, and summer months, when vacation or increased workloads are more likely.

Technical Risks: Compatibility issues are fairly likely because Baker Tilly uses a wide range of client systems, some of which don't natively connect to Tableau. While many of the systems can be routed through the Power BI software, not all platforms are covered by those two ecosystems. For unsupported systems, third-party connectors, data warehousing solutions, or custom application program interface (API) can be explored to enable integration.

Resources: Staffing will be a big focus and cause a high probability of risk. Among the largest organizations surveyed in 2016, a lack of resources made up for a total of 15% of the BI implementation issues (BARC, 2017). Specialized cloud and data talent shortages are common. Current Baker Tilly Business Intelligence employees are specialized in Power BI and will require ample training on Tableau. Luckily, due to recent layoffs, it is currently an employer's market where computer and mathematical occupations unemployment rate is around an all-time high since September 2020 (YCharts, 2025). If Talent Attraction acts fast, they might be able to leverage this market and acquire the resources needed.

Training: Training gaps are common problems during software rollouts. However, Baker Tilly has a strong L&D function to help mitigate some of these gaps. In order to eliminate decision-making delays due to a limited number of data scientists and resources, the firm should consider utilizing the self-service functions (Stair & Reynolds, 2018). This will increase the scope of employees needing to be trained. There is no universal approach for L&D as these individuals have different backgrounds and technological acumen. They will also need to learn Tableau while accomplishing their existing workload. To have a successful adaptation, it is essential that end users are aware of Tableau's capacities and are optimally positioned to maximize its use (Gupta, 2024). Training presents a moderate risk.

Security: The organization must adhere to many strict compliance laws, making this a moderate risk. Baker Tilly already has strong security policies and governance practices in place, meaning data security chances of breach are lower but never zero. Baker Tilly can mitigate these risks through encryption, access controls, and real-time monitoring. As cyber threats continue to evolve, the firm must be proactive by continuously updating its security infrastructure and incident response protocols.

Change Management: Employee buy-in is critical for the success of the Tableau implementation. Resistance to change is a high risk with any new technology deployment. Existing end users may give pushback or revert to their old habits. Key factors contributing to resistance include cultural objection, unclear metrics, and the perception that the software has little impact on individual or team success (BARC, 2017). New systems create conflict, confusion, and disruption as employees change how they were doing prior reporting to the new BI software (Stair & Reynolds, 2018). A strong Change Management team must proactively engage stakeholders, communicate the purpose and benefits clearly, offer hands-on training and support, and involve end users early in the process to foster ownership and trust.

By proactively identifying and addressing these six key risk areas, Baker Tilly can enhance the likelihood of a successful Tableau implementation. With thoughtful planning and ongoing support, the firm can ensure that the transition to Tableau not only meets technical expectations but also aligns with the organizational culture and long-term strategic goals.

Information Systems Security

The number of cybercrimes committed against organizations have increased over the years. In a forecast by Petrosyan (2025), it was estimated that cybercrimes will amount to more than $639 billion lost in the United States. The monetary loss is not the only concern of a breach, but it also causes a disruption to operations, impact on business valuation, and damage to the company's reputation (Petrosyan). Baker Tilly handles sensitive client information and operates under strict compliance requirements making it essential to ensure the confidentiality, integrity, and availability (CIA) of its data. The CIA triad refers to the keeping of sensitive information private and secure, the completeness and accuracy of data and the organization's ability to protect it, and the organization's ability to access information when needed (Irwin, 2023). By taking key security measures, Baker Tilly can ensure that their data, and the data from their clients, remains secure and safe.

Baker Tilly must be particularly attentive to various types of security threats, as they are a prime target due to their presence in the financial services industry. Phishing is one of the biggest security risks for an organization. According to a report conducted by Comcast Business Cybersecurity, 80%-90% of breaches are initiated by a phishing attack (Baker & Cartier, 2025). Additionally, Trojan horses, or seemingly harmless programs in which malicious code is hidden can be another tactic for unwanted malware. These often create a "backdoor" to a system that allows attackers to gain future access to the system (Stair & Reynolds, 2018). In 2025, it was reported that nearly six in every 10 organizations in the US was hit by a ransom attack within the past year (Petrosyan, 2025). Security threats, or insider threats, is the potential for an insider to use their authorized access or understanding to harm the organization, both intentional and unintentional. This can include malicious insiders or incidents caused by human error like accidental data exposure (America's Cyber Defense Agency, n.d.). Misuse of access privileges can allow individuals to view information beyond the scope of their roles or responsibilities. An example would be an HR Administrator accessing Tableau to see the compensation of their peers. Given the frequency and sophistication of these threats, it is critical for Baker Tilly to proactively implement robust security measures to mitigate risks and protect sensitive information.

In order to protect the firm's data, security measures must be put in place. If there were ever to be a breach with the Tableau software, client data could be at risk. "The key is to implement a layered security solution to make computer break-ins so difficult that an attacker eventually gives up" (Stair & Reynolds, 2018, p. 425). Baker Tilly must establish a security policy which describes the responsibility and expected behaviors of the end users. This policy should include measures such as implementing a next-generation firewall (NGFW) which acts as a barrier to block unauthorized access and sophisticated attacks. A security dashboard should be used to monitor access and usage within Tableau. This will help quickly identify unusual activity and potential threats. Integrating tools like an Intrusion Detection System (IDS) can support this by detecting exposures, policy compliance issues, and incident alerts.

Regular security audits should be conducted to evaluate whether the Baker Tilly security policies set in place are being followed and whether system safeguards are functioning as intended. To protect against malicious insiders, IS staff should promptly delete Tableau access accounts after separation. They must also create role-based access controls, so users are only authorized to perform tasks related to their responsibilities (Stair & Reynolds, 2018). Access control can help prevent situations like an HR Administrator viewing peer compensation in Tableau. Furthermore, data encryption protects sensitive information by transforming it into a form that is unreadable to unauthorized individuals (Cocoara, 2023). It is essential for Baker Tilly to encrypt their data at rest and the data that is in transit into the Tableau system. This added layer of security ensures that even if unauthorized access occurs, the data remains secure and unusable.

Lastly, training and awareness should be emphasized to the entire company population to recognize security threats like phishing and to follow security protocols. This is crucial in preventing human error that lead to security breaches. By combining these layered security practices, Baker Tilly can strengthen its defense against cyber threats and ensure the continued protection and integrity of sensitive business and client data.

Ensuring the security of Baker Tilly's data, particularly sensitive client information, requires a comprehensive and layered approach to protect against the evolving landscape of cyber threats. By implementing robust security measures, Baker Tilly can significantly reduce the risk of breaches. With these proactive steps, the firm can effectively safeguard its data and uphold its commitment to maintaining the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of its own and its client's sensitive data.

Information Systems Privacy

Security and privacy are directly related to technology and ethics. While data security protects data against unauthorized access or breach, privacy is an important social issue related to the rights individuals and businesses have over their information and how organizations handle that data (Stair & Reynolds, 2018). "Our most basic duty of care as custodians of user data is to protect both the security of the data itself and the privacy of our users" (Rand-Hendriksen, 2019, 00:40). Baker Tilly works with a variety of client data, and it is the firm's responsibility to ensure it is collected, stored, and used appropriately.

Due to the nature of Baker Tilly's business, the firm must adhere to strict legislation on the data that the firm will be working with. Being within Public Accounting, the firm must adhere to the Gramm-Leach-Bliley Act, Sarbanes-Oxley Act (SOX), Federal Trade Commission (FTC) Act, and the Tax Reform Act (Stair & Reynolds, 2018). These regulations, which are specific to the financial and professional services sector, are designed to protect consumer data, ensure financial transparency, and promote ethical business practices. Baker Tilly must also adhere to the laws governing over the industries of their clients. They work with data related construction, energy, family, financial services, government contracting, healthcare, education, law, manufacturing, not-for-profit, real estate, and tribal governments (Baker Tilly, n.d.). Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA), Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA), and Federal Information Security Modernization Act (FISMA) are some examples of industry specific legislation that Baker Tilly must follow when handling their clients' data (Stair & Reynolds, 2018). Additionally, the firm must follow local ordinances in the areas where they provide services. California alone has more than 25 state privacy and data security laws including the well-known California Consumer Privacy Act (CCPA). Beyond California, 19 other states have implemented a comprehensive state privacy law (DLA Piper, 2025). All of these regulations require Baker Tilly to obtain user consent, clearly disclose data collection practices, and uphold users' rights regarding their information. In addition to legal requirements, the firm has the ethical responsibility to respect privacy, which includes collecting only necessary data and using it solely for the purpose it was originally intended.

In addition to adhering to federal and state regulations, Baker Tilly outlines its own comprehensive privacy practices through its online privacy policy (https://www.bakertilly.com/page/baker-tilly-online-privacy-policy). The firm provides full transparency about how the personal data is collected, including through client interaction, web activity, and third-party sources (Baker Tilly, n.d.). This aligns with the principles of informed consent and ethical data stewardship. Baker Tilly also recognizes individuals' rights to access, correct, or delete their data and provides formal process to support these requests. Furthermore, the firm practices data minimization, or limits the collection of information to what is directly relevant and necessary to accomplish a specific project. The firm only retains the data for as long as it is necessary to fulfill that purpose (European Data Protection Supervisor, n.d.). Clients are also made aware of how their online behavior is tracked through cookies and are given the option to control these settings (Baker Tilly, n.d.). By incorporating these practices when utilizing the Tableau software, Baker Tilly not only complies with privacy laws, but also upholds the trust of its clients through ethical and transparent data management.

In summary, Baker Tilly's approach to information systems privacy encompasses regulatory compliance, ethical responsivity, and proactive data governance. By prioritizing data minimization, honoring user rights, and implementing robust security measures, the firm demonstrates its commitment to protecting sensitive information. This approach not only safeguards the organization and its clients but also strengthens credibility and trust with stakeholders.

Change Management

Change management is one of the biggest challenges for the success of the Tableau implementation. Change is hard for people as it disrupts their routine and introduces conflict and confusion. It only happens when employees accept the need for change and believe that it will improve their productivity and enable them to better meet their clients' needs (Stair & Reynolds, 2018). If Baker Tilly fails to implement a successful change management program, then the likelihood of project failure significantly increases. However, there are proven techniques to assist end users with the transition. The change management team will assist those that will experience this change to adapt their behaviors, expectations and actions to make use of the new Tableau system (Wick, 2022). To guide the transition effectively, the team will apply the ADKAR model. The ADKAR model is a structured approach to change management that focuses on Awareness, Desire, Knowledge, Ability, and Reinforcement. See Table 2.

Table 2

ADKAR Framework for Tableau Change Management

ADKAR Elements	Application to Tableau Implementation
Awareness	• Awareness of the need for change. • Understanding why Tableau is being implemented.
Desire	• Desire to participate in and support the change. • Motivating staff to embrace Tableau.
Knowledge	• Knowledge about how to change. • Training users on how to use Tableau effectively.
Ability	• Ability to implement required skills and behaviors. • Using Tableau in daily workflows.
Reinforcement	• Reinforcement to sustain the change. • Ongoing support, recognition, or performance incentives

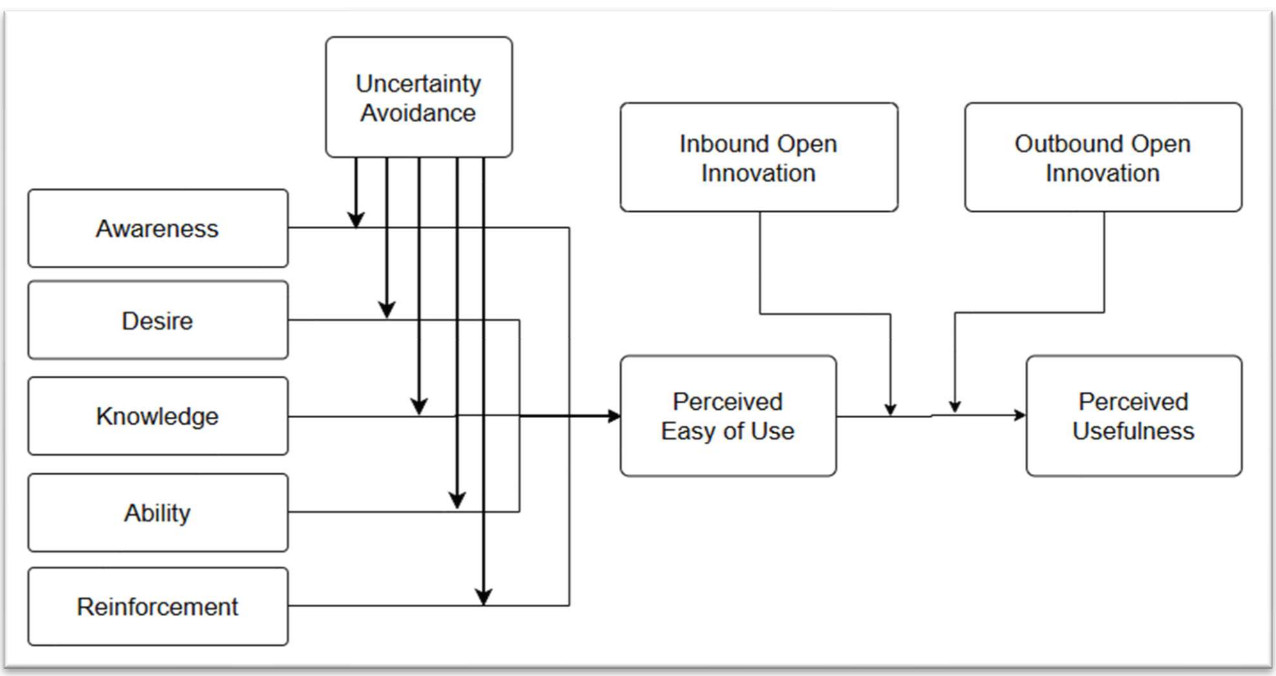
Note. This table illustrates how the ADKAR change management model can be applied to support the implementation and adoption of Tableau software within Baker Tilly.

The ADKAR model emphasizes individual transformation and has been shown to be effective in guiding organizations through technological change. This model is particularly suitable for a large-scale Tableau rollout, as it systematically addresses resistance by first helping employees understand the need for change and then empowering them with the knowledge and ability of the new technology (Ali et al., 2021). Unlike more structural models like Lewin's or Leavitt's, this model gives specific guidance on building user engagement and capability which is crucial for a tool like Tableau (Stair & Reynolds, 2018). By applying ADKAR, Baker Tilly can better manage the human side of technology change and reduce the risk of project failure.

Baker Tilly will see several benefits by using the ADKAR model. Firstly, it avoids uncertainty. This model helps create clarity at each stage of the change process. End users at Baker Tilly may be hesitant to adopt Tableau due to unfamiliarity or fear of failure. By building awareness and knowledge, the model lowers anxiety and promotes confidence in the system. It also emphasizes building and applying new knowledge in the "Knowledge" and "Ability" stage. This is vital in the Tableau rollout as users must not only understand its functions but also integrate it into their workflows. ADKAR ensures effective internal knowledge transfer across departments and end users. Lastly, the model supports open innovation. It does this by encouraging both internal adoption and external collaboration. Inbound innovation occurs as employees adapt to Tableau's tools. Outbound innovation can happen as the firm shares their insights or efficiencies externally with clients. The model's reinforcement stage helps sustain this dynamic and encourages continued innovation beyond initial adoption (Ali et al., 2021). Figure 2 is the conceptual framework of the ADKAR model.

Figure 2

ADKAR Conceptual Framework



Note. Adapted from" The power of ADKAR change model in innovative technology acceptance under the moderating effect of culture and open innovation" by M. A. Ali, A. Mahmood, U. Zafar, and M. Nazim, 2021, *LogForum, 17*(4), p. 491. https://doi.org/10.17270/J.LOG.2021.623

The ADKAR model provides Baker Tilly with a comprehensive, people focused approach to managing the transition into Tableau. By focusing on the individual's journey through change, ADKAR reduces resistance and enhances adoption. This structured framework not only ensures that employees are prepared and supported but also promotes sustained innovation and organizational resilience. With a clearly defined path for change, Baker Tilly can increase the likelihood of a successful Tableau implementation.

Recommendations/Conclusions

To support Baker Tilly's continued growth and enhance its data capabilities, it is recommended that the firm implement Tableau as a complementary BI tools alongside Power BI. Power BI remains a strong asset within the Microsoft ecosystem. However, the growing complexity of client needs, limitations of cross-platform integration, and the increasing volume and variety of data call for an addition of a more flexible and powerful BI environment.

Tableau's strengths are system interconnectivity, large dataset handling, and intuitive visualization make it an ideal solution for Baker Tilly's multi-cloud infrastructure. By integrating Tableau into the BI framework, the firm will break down data silos, enable real-time data insights, and enable more strategic decision-making across departments.

To ensure the success of the Tableau implementation, it is essential for Baker Tilly to invest in staffing, create a robust training program, and utilize the ADKAR model for change management. This will help overcome resistance, build buy-in, and enable employees to leverage the BI software's capabilities. Additionally, enterprise risk management, data security, and privacy protections must be monitored and reinforced to maintain compliance and client trust.

Tableau is a strategic investment that aligns with Baker Tilly's goals of data-driven decision-making, operational efficiency, and strong client service delivery. With careful planning and execution, this initiative will future proof the firm's analytics capabilities and create a competitive advantage.

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